

Transport networks 传输网

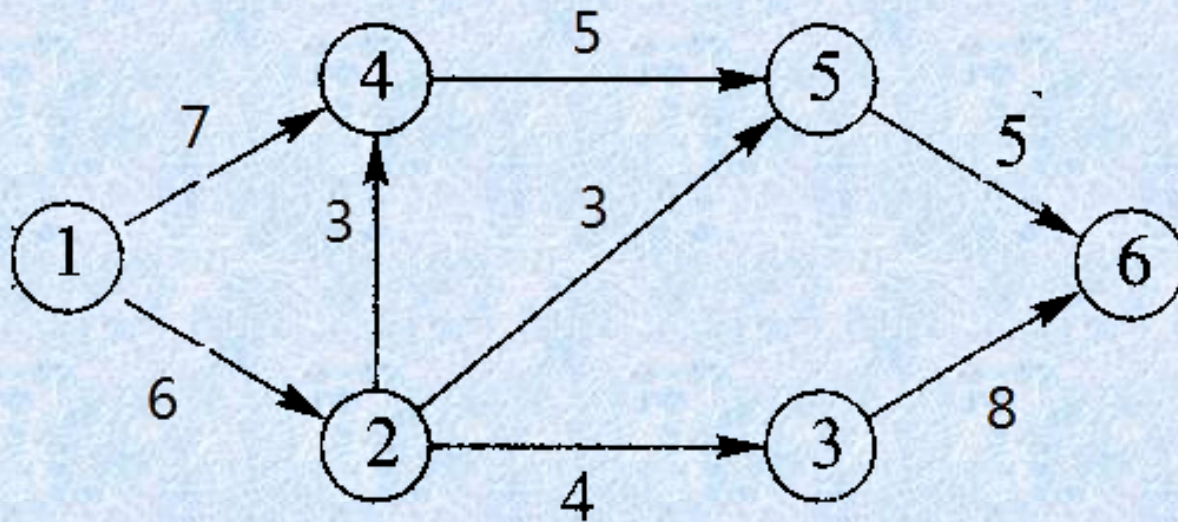
- Basic concepts
- Labeling algorithm
- The Max flow Min Cut Theorem

Directed graph (Digraph)

- An important use of labeled digraphs is to model what are commonly called transport networks.
- The label on an edge represents the maximum flow that can be passed through that edge and is called the *capacity* (容量) of the edge. Many situations can be modeled in this way.

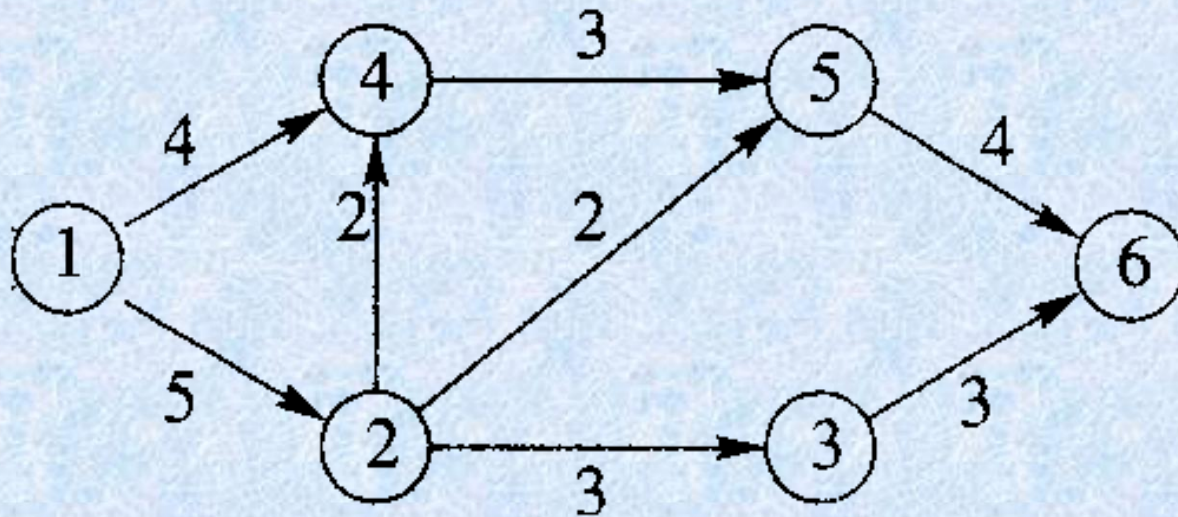
Example

- Figure below might as easily represent an oil pipeline, a highway system, a communications network, or an electric power grid.



Example

- The vertices of a network are usually called nodes and may denote pumping stations, shipping depots, relay stations, or highway interchanges.



Transport network

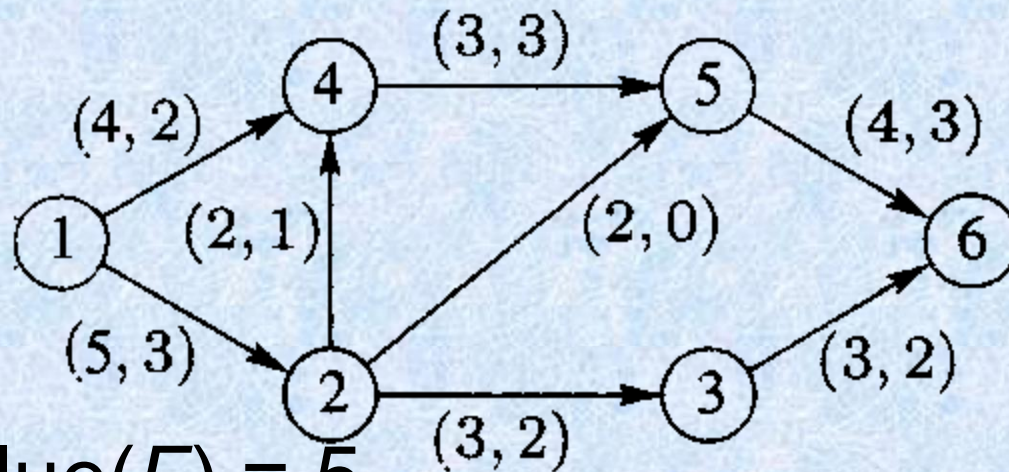
- More formally, a *transport network*, or a *network*, is a connected digraph N with the following properties:
 - There is a unique node, the *source* (源端), that has in-degree 0. We generally label the source node 1.
 - There is a unique node, the *sink* (宿端), that has out-degree 0. If N has n nodes, we generally label the sink as node n .
 - The graph N is labeled. The label, C_{ij} , on edge (i, j) is a nonnegative number called the *capacity* of the edge.

Flows

- Mathematically, a *flow* (流量) in a network N is a function that assigns to each edge (i, j) of N a nonnegative number F_{ij} that does not exceed C_{ij} .
 - *Conservation of flow* (流量守恒)
 - *Value of the flow*

Flows

- We can represent a flow F by labeling each edge (i, j) with the pair (C_{ij}, F_{ij})



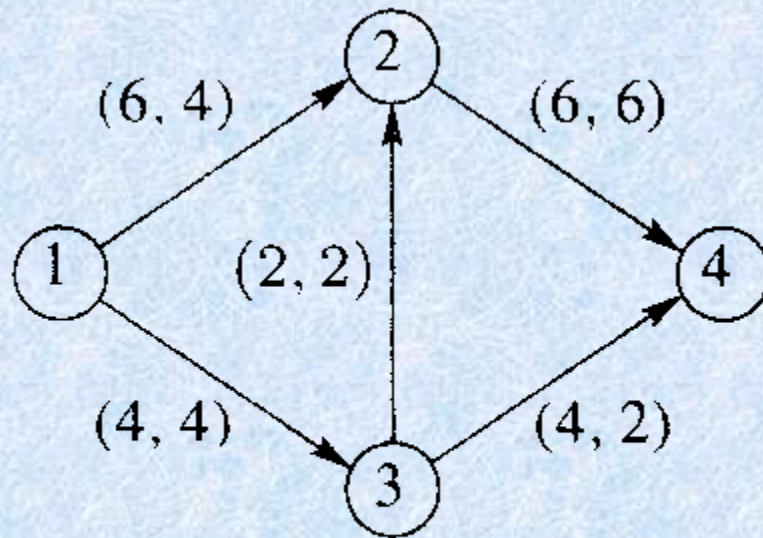
- Here $\text{value}(F) = 5$

Maximum Flows (最大流量)

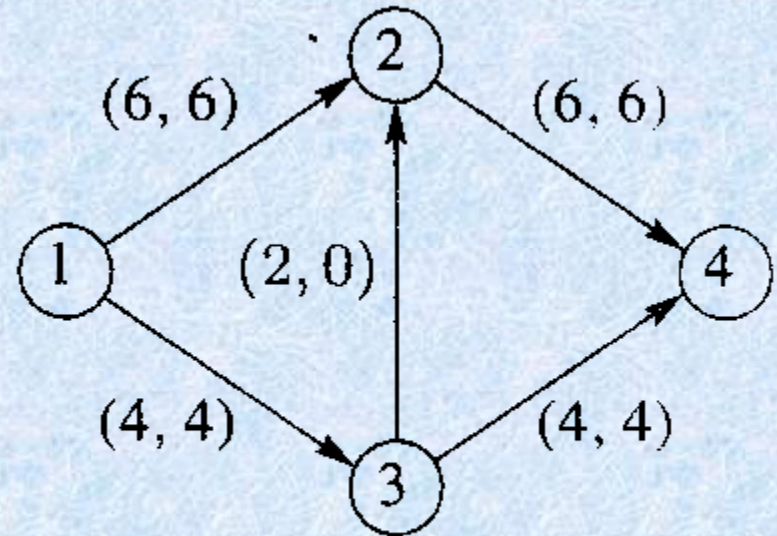
- For any network an important problem is to determine the maximum value of a flow through the network and to describe a flow that has the maximum value.
- For obvious reasons this is commonly referred to the *maximum flow problem*.

Example 2

- Even for a small network, we need a systematic procedure for solving the maximum flow problem.

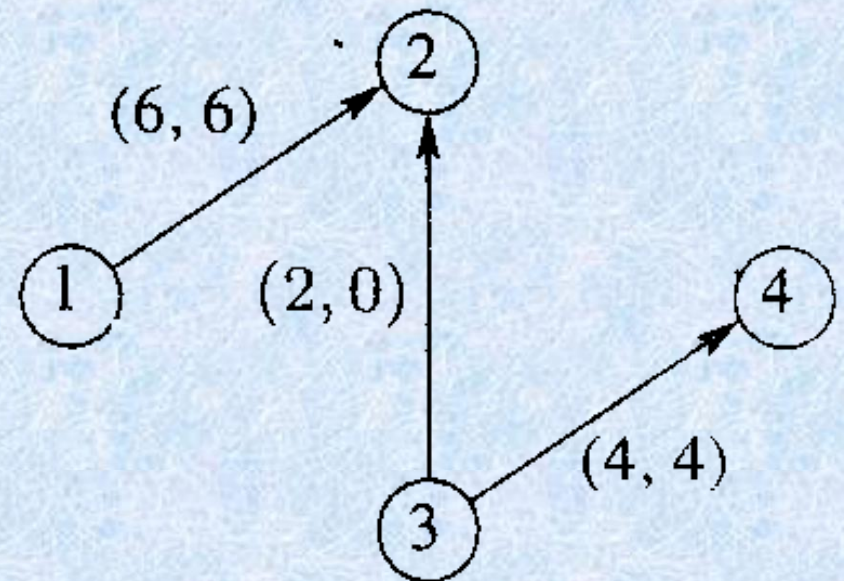
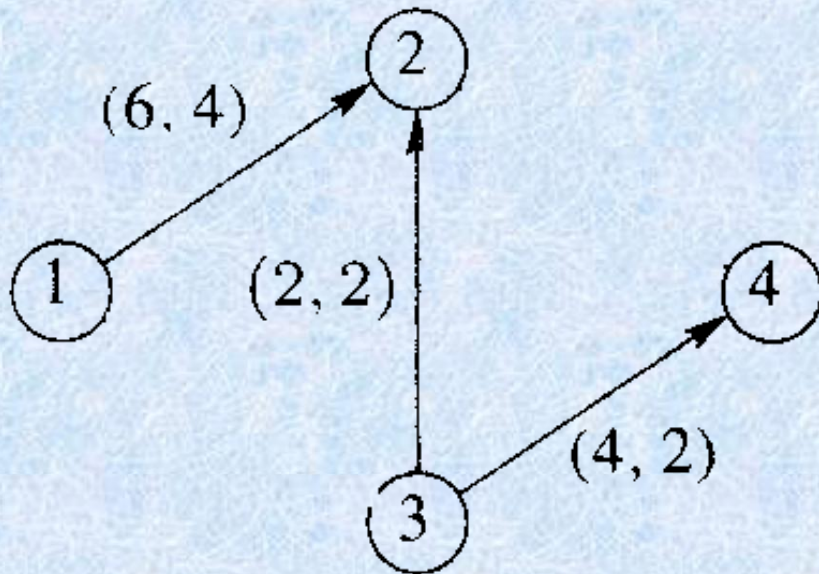


(a)



(b)

Virtual Flow



- Let N be a network and let G be the symmetric closure of N .
 - Choose a path in G and let an edge (i,j) in this path.
 - If $(i,j) \in N$ and $e_{ij} = C_{ij} - F_{ij} > 0$, then we say this edge has positive excess capacity.
 - If (i,j) is not an edge of N then we are traveling this edge in the wrong direction. $E_{ij} = F_{ji}$ if $F_{ji} > 0$. Increasing flow through edge (i,j) will have the effect of reducing F_{ji} .

LABELING ALGORITHM

- The algorithm we present is due to Ford and Fulkerson and is often called the *labeling algorithm* (标记算法). The labeling referred to is an additional labeling of nodes. We have used integer capacities for simplicity, but Ford and Fulkerson show that this algorithm will stop in a finite number of steps if the capacities are rational numbers.

LABELING ALGORITHM

- Let N be a network with n nodes and G be the symmetric closure of N . All edges and paths used are in G .
 - Begin with all flows set to 0.
 - As we proceed, it will be convenient to track the excess capacities in the edges and how they change rather than tracking the increasing flows.
 - When the algorithm terminates, it is easy to find the maximum flow from the final excess capacities.

Step 1

- Let N_1 be the set of all nodes connected to the source by an edge with positive excess capacity.
- Label each j in N_1 with $[E_j, l]$, where E_j is the excess capacity e_{lj} of edge (l, j) .
- The l in the label indicates that j is connected to the source, node l .

Step 2

- Let node j in N_1 be the node with **smallest node number** and let $N_2(j)$ be the set of all unlabeled nodes, other than the source, that are joined to node j and have positive excess capacity.
- Suppose that node k is in $N_2(j)$ and (j, k) is the edge with positive excess capacity. Label node k with $[E_k, j]$, where E_k is the minimum of E_j and the excess capacity e_{jk} of edge (j, k) .
- When all the nodes in $N_2(j)$ are labeled in this way, repeat this process for the other nodes in N_1 . Let

$$N_2 = \bigcup_{j \in N_1} N_2(j)$$

Step 3

- Repeat Step 2, labeling all previously unlabeled nodes N_3 that can be reached from a node in N_2 by an edge having positive excess capacity.
- Continue this process forming sets $N_4, N_5, \dots$ until after a finite number of steps either
 - (i) the sink has not been labeled and no other nodes can be labeled. It can happen that no nodes have been labeled; remember that the source is not labeled.
or
 - (ii) the sink has been labeled.

Step 4

- In case (i), the algorithm terminates and the total flow then is a maximum flow.

Step 5

- In case (ii) the sink, node n , has been labeled with $[E_n, m]$ where E_n is the amount of extra flow that can be made to reach the sink through a path π .

Step 5

- We examine π in reverse order.
 - If edge $(i, j) \in N$, then we increase the flow in (i, j) by E_n and **decrease** the excess capacity e_{ij} by the same amount. Simultaneously, we **increase** the excess capacity of the (virtual) edge (j, i) by E_n since there is that much more flow in (i, j) to reverse.
 - If, on the other hand, $(i, j) \notin N$, we **decrease** the flow in (j, i) by E_n and **increase** its excess capacity by E_n . We simultaneously decrease the excess capacity in (i, j) by the same amount, since there is less flow in (i, j) to reverse.
 - We now have a new flow that is E_n units greater than before and we return to Step 1.